

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



Edition No.: 99

 Housing Recovery and  
Reconstruction Platform  
**BULLETIN**  
4 February 2019



**Ward No.3, Bethanchok Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok:** a brick and cement mortar masonry house. The home owner constructed the house similar to the pre-earthquake one but using different materials. It was a stone and mud mortar masonry house before. The owner later added the front porch with a small gap to the main building as suggested by the engineers. The home owner has received all three tranches GoN housing grant. The total cost of construction was 2,000,000 NPRs (approximately USD 17,500). This is sourced from the [HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, District Report, 18 – 31 Jan 2019](#).

## Featured Technical Staff Person



*Sona Bade*  
*Field Engineer, Lalitpur Metropolitan City*

This week's featured technical staff person is Sona Bade who has been working as a field engineer in Lalitpur Metropolitan City since December 2017.

Sona first began working on the reconstruction in April 2016 and she was based in Dhading as part of the Building DLPIU.

Sona shares an overview of her experience, the challenges she has faced, and reflects on some of the actions required to better support households through the reconstruction process.

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## Highlights

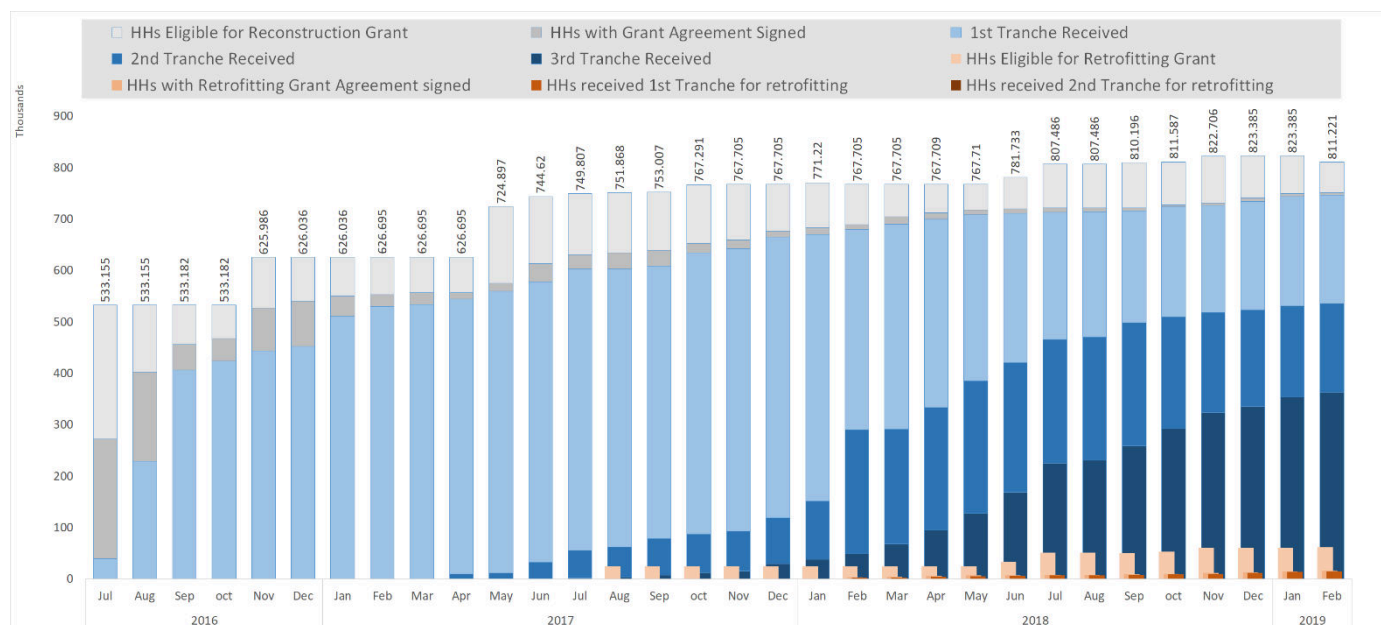
- Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG), Working Sessions, 7 & 14 February, 1-5PM, HRRP Office
  - [Working Together for Disaster Relief - How can the private sector better work with the humanitarian sector in pre- and post-disaster reconstruction and development to reinforce local ownership and support localisation?, BRE Event, 8 February, UK](#)
  - Affordable Housing in Nepali Cities, 8 February, 9:30-12:15, DFID Nepal Ekantakuna
  - [Launch of ALNAP Earthquake Lessons Paper, 13 February, 10:00-13:00, Dhokaima Cafe](#)
  - [REMINDER, HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey Round 4](#): the deadline for completing the survey has been extended to 8 February (Friday)
  - [NRA Newsletter January 2019](#)
  - [Municipal Association of Nepal \(MuAN\) Mobile App](#)
  - [National Association of Rural Municipalities in Nepal \(NARMIN\) Mobile App](#)
  - [EHA Connect, 'Connecting Environment and Humanitarian Action'](#)
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## National Updates

**NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 4 February:**

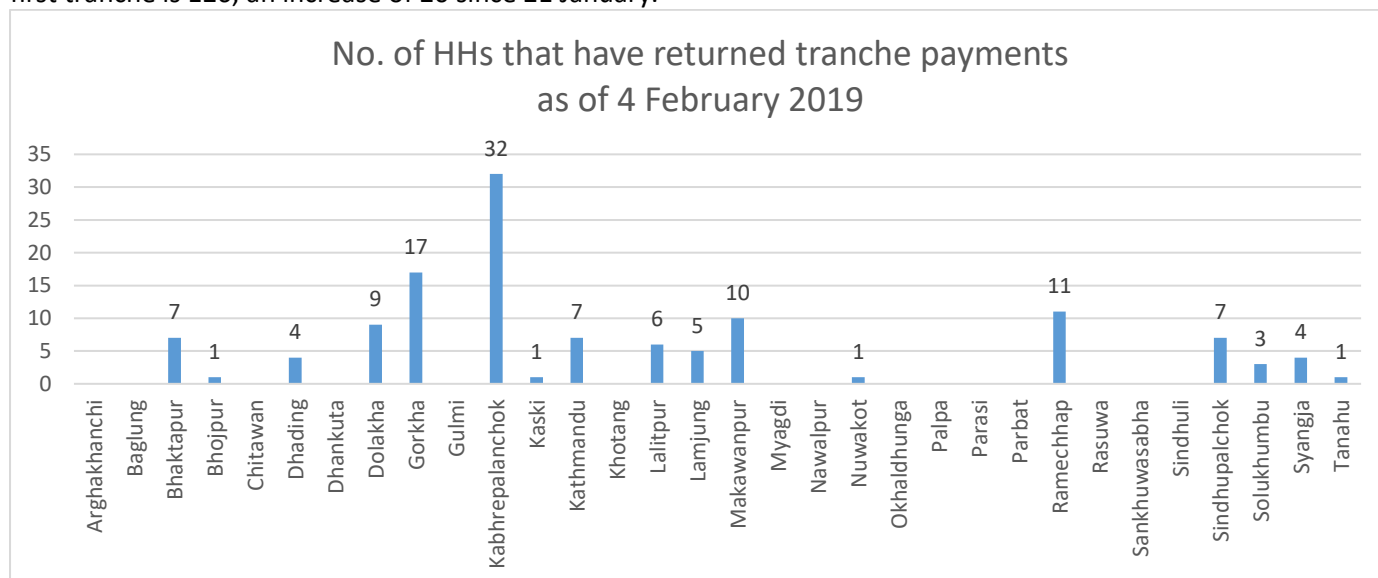
| Reconstruction Grant                     | 7 January | 21 January | 4 February |
|------------------------------------------|-----------|------------|------------|
| Total No. Eligible HHs                   | 823,385   | 811,154*   | 811,221*   |
| HHs Enrolled                             | 744,228   | 749,783    | 751,790    |
| HHs Received 1 <sup>st</sup> Tranche     | 738,430   | 744,050    | 746,853    |
| HHs Applied for 2 <sup>nd</sup> Tranche  | 542,667   | 549,549    | 557,904    |
| HHs Received 2 <sup>nd</sup> Tranche     | 526,794   | 531,210    | 536,030    |
| Non-compliant at 2 <sup>nd</sup> Tranche | 4,599     | 4,673      | 4,713      |
| HHs Applied for 3 <sup>rd</sup> Tranche  | 381,097   | 386,136    | 395,255    |
| HHs Received 3 <sup>rd</sup> Tranche     | 342,839   | 354,396    | 363,640    |
| Non-compliant at 3 <sup>rd</sup> Tranche | 2,506     | 2,431      | 2,708      |
| Houses Completed                         | 347,748   | 350,762    | 365,831    |
| HHs with Completion Certificate          | 4,421     | 4,560      | 4,462      |
|                                          |           |            |            |
| Retrofit Grant                           | 7 January | 21 January | 4 February |
| Total No. Eligible HHs                   | 61,591    | 61,591     | 61,836     |
| HHs Enrolled                             | 15,025    | 15,462     | 16,695     |
| HHs Received 1 <sup>st</sup> Tranche     | 13,689    | 14,148     | 15,672     |
| HHs Received 2 <sup>nd</sup> Tranche     | 4         | 20         | 23         |

\*the total number of households eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant has decreased because there had been an error in the numbers reported from Sindhuli and this has now been corrected.



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMALI CLPIU, and Building CLPIU data from July 2016 to 4 February 2019.

**Tracking Return of First Tranche:** numbers are based on data collected by HRRP District Coordination Teams (DCTs) through the GMALI DLPIU offices. As of 4 February, the total number of households that have returned the first tranche is 126, an increase of 20 since 21 January.



**Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG) Update:** the group is now working under a new objective *‘The Vulnerable Support Working Group is strengthened as a platform where consensus is built on best practices regarding modalities to support vulnerable households, with the aim to influence main the reconstruction stakeholders (NRA, GoN, Donors and implementing partners)’*. The VSWG is also now co-chaired by DFID and SDC – many thanks to both for taking this on. The expected outputs / actions for the group, as agreed by the members, include identification of vulnerable households / defining vulnerable criteria, documenting and disseminating best practices for supporting vulnerable households, and developing and sharing advocacy messages on the needs of vulnerable households. The VSWG will be having weekly working sessions on these areas and anyone interested to participate can contact Rupa Pandey ([meal@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:meal@hrrpnepal.org)) or Minar Thapa Magar ([minar@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:minar@hrrpnepal.org)) for more information.

**Asia Foundation, Public Policy Dialogue (PPD) event, on “Status of Post-Earthquake Recovery and Reconstruction Services: Current Scenario”, 1 February:** the focus of the event was an Asia Foundation report, “Political economy analysis of post-earthquake reconstruction in Nepal: An assessment of emerging role of local governments”. The objective of the report is to highlight the emerging political economy issues in the role of local governments in the post-earthquake reconstruction and to reflect how the local governments are positioning themselves to expedite the reconstruction process, and manage implementation of building codes, thereby assuring people’s right to safe and dignified homes. The study team presented the report which identified five gaps; understanding of citizen’s needs, design of reconstruction process, delivering reconstruction services, communication, and perception of services. The report recommended assessing and developing disaster risk management capacity of local government, strengthening institutional memory, mitigating local conflict, strengthening communication, and institutional building. NRA CEO, Mr. Sushil Gyewali, stated that the report should include the NRA perspective including progress made so far and collaboration for further road map. He also highlighted that the report was prepared in August 2018 and there has been much progress since then, for example the signing of an MoU between the NRA and all earthquake affected local governments. He shared that there has been increased public awareness to construction of earthquake resilient homes and that earthquake resilient schools are being constructed.



**Making the Centre Listen: Films from the Edges, Women Speaking Truth to Power:** this event was organised by Accountability Lab Nepal with support from the Canada Fund for Local Initiatives and Onion Films. 25 women from across Nepal received training on film-making, before creating 6 unique short films based on their own experiences of the cross-section between gender and accountability issues. The event was a screening of these 6 films which covered a wide range of topics such as LGBT rights, migration, gender discrimination at home and in the workplace, and the struggle of Dalit women ward members. The film screening was followed by a panel discussion on the issues raised. 'Her Story' is a film-making school for women with a focus on creating visual stories about gender, power relations and accountability.

**Humanitarian Networks and Partnerships Week (HNPW) in Geneva, 4-8 February 2019:** the fifth Humanitarian Networks and Partnerships Week (HNPW) will be held at the International Conference Centre (CICG) in Geneva, Switzerland from 4-8 February 2019. The event will host the annual meetings and consultations of humanitarian Networks and Partnerships and bring together experts in crisis preparedness and response from a diversity of organizations and countries to identify solutions to common humanitarian challenges.

## District & Municipal Updates

**District Level Reconstruction Orientation and Review Workshops, NRA CLPIUs (Building and GMALI):** these workshops have now been completed in all 32 earthquake affected districts – congratulations to everyone involved! The major outcomes of the workshops are NRA signing an MoU ([Nepali](#), [Unofficial English Translation](#)) with each of the municipalities and the municipalities preparing [draft municipal reconstruction action plans](#). Municipal profiles developed as part of the process, which will be updated monthly, are available [here](#).

Videos from the events are available on YouTube. Some recently uploaded videos include interviews with:

- [Maya Rana, Chairperson, Myagde Rural Municipality, Tanahun](#)
- [Ramesh Thapa, Chief administrative officer, Raghuganga Rural Municipality, Myagdi](#)
- [Ramesh Sharma, Chairperson, Phalewas Municipality-1, Parbat](#)

For further information please contact Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP Deputy National Coordinator, [minar@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:minar@hrrpnepal.org).

**HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 18 – 31 Jan 2019:** during this period district coordination meetings took place in Bhaktapur (24 January), Gorkha (29 January), Ramechhap (29 January), Sindhuli (29 January), Nuwakot (30 January), and Sindhupalchok (31 January). Municipal level meetings took place in Rural Municipalities and Municipalities of the following districts: Dhading, Dolakha, Gorkha, Kathmandu, Kavrepalanchok, Lalitpur, Makawanpur, Nuwakot, Okhaldhunga, Ramechhap, Sindhuli, and Sindhupalchok. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Bhaktapur**, it was reported that 30-40% debris from earthquake damaged buildings is still lying in haphazard condition in various parts of the district. There are a few brick and cement mortar masonry houses that can be corrected using the Corrections and Exceptions manual. In Madhyapur Thimi Municipality, many households have requested to change their status from full reconstruction beneficiaries to retrofit beneficiaries. Non-compliance cases with 9 x 12 inch columns are prevalent in Suryabinayak and Changunarayan Municipalities. It was also reported that households have added extra storeys beyond what is specified in their building permits. It was noted that EHRP/DLPIU GMaLI Bhaktapur will prepare environmental and social safeguard management plan of Suryabinayak and Changunarayan Municipalities.
- In **Gorkha**, distribution of completion certificates was discussed, and POs committed to work in coordination with the RMs and Municipalities to ensure the quality of the certificates. Regarding landless issues, there are six landless households who have not been able to do a PA with the government and other 47 landless related issues were solved with regular initiation from PIN/CSRC in the district. The

meeting also discussed on the possibility of assessing one room houses to find the exact number and status in the district.

- In **Ramechhap**, the DSE shared that out of the 1,762 total non-compliant cases registered, 1,452 have been addressed; 865 have been recommended for tranche disbursement and 558 have been recommended for corrections. In January 2019, 61 non-compliance issue have been registered in Ramechhap district. Among them 40 cases have been given solution and recommended for tranche. A total of 21 have been recommended for correction. The number of non-compliance issues has been reduced due to presence of POs and their support in the field.
- In **Sindhuli**, Ward No. 6, Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, local people complained that 50 households in the area are “fake beneficiaries” who have signed the PA and received tranches even though they should not be eligible. This is NRCS/ERO working area, so further investigation will be done by the concerned stakeholders. The meeting also decided to discuss on efficient and timely tranche disbursement to the beneficiaries with the concerned banks in the district.
- In **Nuwakot**, OXFAM is supporting displaced families from Bhalche, Lachyang, Umleni, and Rasuwa. It has completed support to 24 HHs from Umleni and 47 are under construction. Similarly, OXFAM through implementing partners Sahayata Samajik Sanstha and CARDSN are also supporting displaced families to settle in Bidur and Kharanitar. It is also supporting irrigation canal construction, water supply construction in some areas. 381 HHs were identified as living in geo hazard area by Durable Solutions and of these 207 HHs have purchased land in safe areas, 60 HHs had already constructed houses in safe areas, 82 have safe land and 6 have constructed houses in their other lands. Out of the 77 landless HHs, 44 HHs are planning to move to an integrated settlement in Bidur Municipality. Purnima Project and RSDC are working in the district with another livelihood support.
- In **Sindhupalchok**, main issue raised was Municipal Engineers approving the house designs even if they fail to meet the minimum requirements. The technical persons are thus facing challenge in the field due to this. The displaced HHs that have received second tranche using the land-use approval (manjurunama) from the land owners has posed a serious challenge as there are no procedures from NRA to address the issue. There are currently 142 such households according to CSRC/Durable Solutions. There is still confusion regarding how to return the tranche to the government. Acting GMAI Chief advised that the household should visit the GMAI office themselves and file an application if they wish to return the tranche. UNDP has started revolving fund of amount 50,000 NPRs for reconstruction in Chautara Sangachokgadhi Municipality ward 4 and 8 and Indrawati Rural Municipality wards 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, and 10. Acting GMAI Chief praised the POs for their efforts on reconstruction and requested them to document the activities and maintain integrity.
- **Benighat Rorang RM, Dhading, 22 January:** most of the households have not started construction as they are waiting for the grievance results. The presence of technical persons in the area was found to be satisfactory. The major non-compliance issues in RCC were room size greater than 13.5 sqm, one bay building, insufficient foundation, lack of grid column, and insufficient anchorage bonding. Structural span more than 4.5m, lack of horizontal and vertical bands, sill band, lintel band, plinth band and roof band lack of through stone and inappropriate positioning, and size of openings were some of the non-compliances in load bearing structures. A lack of coordination between the RM and technical persons has created challenges in the area.
- **Tripurasundari RM, Dhading, 28 January:** it was reported that a high number of households have received the government grant, but they have not started construction. RM authorities have been informed of this and they will follow up with the households and encourage them to start reconstruction. There are also some non-compliant houses that have received the grant, perhaps due to pressure from households to get approval for the grant before the NRA tranche disbursement deadline.
- **Khaniyabas RM, Dhading, 31 January:** the main concerns raised were delays in grievance redressal by NRA, landless issues, and switching of household’s support categories (retrofit to reconstruction). It was reported that some people were missed out in the grievance process and delays in addressing the grievance has caused misunderstanding among community and RM/ward offices. Most of the households have not started construction as they are waiting for the grievance result. There are households under the retrofit list who would like to switch to full reconstruction beneficiaries. The ward office, in coordination

with technical persons, have conducted inspection of those houses and forwarded the files to district GMaLI office. A discussion was held on the process of returning the tranche and on the reconstruction completion certificate distribution.

- **Tamakoshi RM, Dolakha, 24 January:** the RM Chairperson expressed satisfaction towards the reconstruction rate in the area. However, he expressed concerns on the size of the houses with mainly two room houses constructed in the area which do not meet the needs of the family. He further said this has resulted in additional storeys, either light or heavy structures, being added which make people more vulnerable to disaster. It was reported that in areas where technical staff have been present, the reconstruction rate is good but in areas where they are not present there is delay in forwarding the file and a low reconstruction rate. GMaLI Chief requested all the concerned stakeholder to coordinate with each other to speed up reconstruction. DLPIU/Building Acting Chief also informed of constructing earthquake resistant structures to minimise risks and further added that few of the non-compliant cases have been forward to CLPIU for detailed analysis and approval for the subsequent tranche.
- **Gandaki RM, Gorkha, 21 January:** ODRC/UNDP presented the reconstruction status of their supported wards and HRRP presented the reconstruction status of other wards of Gandaki rural municipality. The meeting mainly discussed on issues related to duplication, removal of people from the reconstruction grant list, delay in payment of tranche by the banks. GMaLI chief responded by sharing the current working status of GMaLI at district level and assured full support to the households. The Chairperson of Gandaki RM expressed concerns on reconstruction in the area and assured more follow up with the households from ward level to expedite the process.
- **Siranchok RM, Gorkha, 25 January:** the meeting mainly discussed on issues related to duplication, removal of people from the reconstruction grant list, list of people with houses in another place, resurvey and verification. GMaLI chief responded by sharing the current working status of GMaLI at district level and assured full support to the households. He also shared about provision in policy for house in another place and shared that unless changes in policy, the people listed would remain the same. Chairperson of Siranchok RM expressed concerns regarding the present procedure of re applying to be included in the list and issues with people having houses in another place. He requested GMaLI Gorkha to coordinate with central NRA for changes in policy on this matter.
- **Sahid Lakhan RM, Gorkha, 28 January:** the chairperson shared that there have been efforts from the RM to expedite the reconstruction process. The meeting mainly discussed issues related to duplication, removal of people from the reconstruction list, and delays in payment of tranches by the banks. GMaLI chief responded by sharing the current working status of GMaLI at district level and assured full support to the households. Chairperson of Sahid Lakhan RM also added that the households who have taken first tranche and are not willing to reconstruct should be clearly identified and there should be some provision for the vulnerable households. He also shared that there is now provision of revolving fund of 100,000 NPRs available to households to speed up reconstruction.
- **Ward No. 2, Kirtipur Municipality, Kathmandu, 22 January:** due to large family size, most of the households have added up to 5 more storeys than mentioned in the building permit, this has made difficulties for proceeding with the third tranche. Other issues in the area include small land parcels and multiple beneficiaries residing in same house in small units in multiple storey without having any legal document or land ownership. Many of the old BMM houses attached to damaged houses are vulnerable and at risk of collapsing when the damaged houses are demolished for reconstruction.
- **Ward 3, Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu, 31 January:** a total of 242 households have signed the PA with the GoN and have received first tranche too. Of these, only 85 of them have accessed the second tranche and 52 have secured the third tranche. The key reconstruction issue is that some households are residing on Parti land (government owned land) because of which they don't have legal land ownership papers. Plot allocation of beneficiary's land and property is another reconstruction issue. Issue of tenants and land owners' cases (mohi & talsing) is still prevalent in the ward. Nearly 26 households, out of 50 earthquake affected households that have struggled on land ownership issues of Parti land have accessed land ownership certificates through public inquiry deed process.
- **Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu, 31 January:** a total of 4,084 households have been identified as eligible for the reconstruction grant and 3,718 have received first tranche, 1,177 have accessed second

tranche, and 668 have secured third tranche. The key reconstruction issues are related with land disputes over Guthi land, issues of houses made on various kinds of birta land, barren land, and cases of multiple beneficiaries. Plot allocation is another issue that has resulted in small parcels of land left for quake affected households which are not suitable for building a house. Environment and social safeguard verification in various parts of Dakshinkali Municipality is going on.

- **Ward 2, Bethanchok RM, Kavrepalanchok, 31 January:** while the number of households receiving second tranche is higher, those receiving third tranche is lower. Most of the households have built up to plinth level and have not progressed beyond that. The major non-compliances in the area are associated with the houses built immediately after the earthquake, before the mobilisation of technical persons.
- **Ward 11, Lalitpur Metropolitan City, Lalitpur, 24 January,** major challenges to reconstruction are small parcel of lands, and households residing in multiple storey in same house and not having legal documents. Some households have started reconstruction by accessing bank loans however, some have not been able to receive bank loans despite continuous struggle. It was reported that a few households have not been able to start reconstruction due to poor economic condition and are compelled to live in the damaged houses or in temporary shelters. There is also a problem with removing rubble in core areas like Banglamukhi, Kumbheshwor, and Ikachhen due to narrow roads.
- **Ward 1, Konjyosom RM, Lalitpur, 28 January:** there are only two technical staff present which is insufficient in the ward. It was reported that the non-compliance issues in the ward have been increasing and there was contradiction in the information provided by the technical staff. The houses said to be compliant before has been listed as non-compliant now. Around 12-13 houses in the ward constructed immediately after the earthquake are non-compliant. Among 54 grievances filed only 9 have been addressed; 4 under retrofitting and 5 under full damage. Many households have been left out, so the final round of grievance collection is going to be conducted soon under the ward office with support from the technical staff which hopefully will address those affected by the earthquake. The cases of households wanting to change from retrofitting to full reconstruction are still pending. The Ward Chief clarified on returning the tranche if any households fail to rebuild or are not willing to build houses and said they will not be able to get the government or ward services if they do not return the tranche. He also requested households to construct the house as per their need and discouraged building one roomed structure.
- **Ward no 5, Konjyosom RM, Lalitpur, 28 January:** the ward has 240 beneficiaries under retrofitting. All the beneficiaries under retrofitting have requested to change to full reconstruction beneficiaries list. The ward office has prepared the necessary documents and the files are ready to be forwarded to GMaLI office, Lalitpur. Most of the houses under retrofitting are load bearing stone in mud mortar / brick in mud mortar. The ward office has planned to conduct a census to find the necessary areas to be included in the development plan of the ward. The reconstruction sector is also included in the plan where each beneficiary will be consulted to find the issue/challenges in building their house. For this the ward office has finalized the questionnaire and the census will begin 2nd week of February. The technical staffs have been very active and helping beneficiaries to build earthquake resistant structures and encouraging beneficiaries to start reconstruction and complete within the government timeframe.
- **Ward 5, Mahankal RM, Lalitpur, 29 January:** interactions with beneficiaries revealed that majority of them have not taken the second tranche as their houses were constructed before the endorsement of guidelines or deployment of engineers in the field by NRA. Engineers have conducted inspection of those houses, but they have not accessed second tranche as proper decisions have not been made from central NRA regarding providing second and third tranche to houses that were reconstructed earlier. Some local masons of Chandanpur areas have received mason training too and went on to build compliant houses thereafter. However, it was found that some houses have missed lintel and roof bands.
- **Ward 6, Raksirang RM Makwnapur, 23 January:** the reconstruction is moving at good pace and the ward chief informed that except the new beneficiaries added from the grievance list, reconstruction of houses will be completed within the timeframe stipulated by NRA. The meeting briefly discussed on the final inspection and Completion Certificate Distribution. District team agreed to provide Final Inspection Forms to field technicians. It was also agreed to initiate CS entry of the completed houses. The ward chief also agreed to mobilise local Community Based Organizations to speed up reconstruction in the area.



- **Ward 12 Bidur Municipality, Nuwakot, 29 January:** there are 1,004 beneficiaries, out of which 966 have received first tranche, 918 have received second tranche and 436 have received third tranche. Mainly the non-compliant issues are found in the semi urban area with SMM structures and RCC structures in lower parts of the ward and with houses built near to the roads. Ward Chief expressed concerns regarding the grievance results as they have been facing pressure from the beneficiaries. The ward has registered 68 grievances and none of them have been addressed.
- **Ward 8, Siddhicharan Municipality, Okhaldhunga, 21 January:** there was discussion on dissatisfaction of the people regarding the resurvey as many houses were left out and they are expecting a resurvey again by the Government. There are retrofit beneficiaries who are not willing to retrofit their houses but rather would like to switch to full reconstruction beneficiaries.
- **Ward 8, Molung RM, Okhaldhunga, 22 January:** there are still some beneficiaries who have received first tranche but not started rebuilding the houses. Ward office will make a list of those beneficiaries, identify the reasons of not starting and will follow up with them. The meeting discussed on the NRA tranche deadline since many people were unclear on the timeframe of reconstruction.
- **Ward 4, Sunapati RM, Ramechhap, 22 January:** the reconstruction rate was reported to be satisfactory as well as the presence and support of technical staff in the field. However, water scarcity in the area has delayed reconstruction and third tranche approval process. 12 HHs have not received first tranche even though they have signed the PA with the government. A total of 230 beneficiaries are in retrofit beneficiaries but they are willing to switch to full reconstruction beneficiaries as most of them have constructed new house. About 150 beneficiaries have appealed for resurvey whereas some beneficiaries are willing to return the tranche as they have houses in other places and some are not willing to construct house in the village. There are about 30-40 HHs that still need to start DPC level construction.
- **Ward 2 Golanjor, Sindhuli 23 January:** of the 254 households, 244 HHs have constructed their houses and received second tranche of the Government housing reconstruction grant. Three houses constructed immediately after the earthquake, before the deployment of technical persons in the field are non-compliant. Beneficiaries who have constructed timber frame houses have not received third tranche of housing grant.
- **Golanjor RM, Sindhuli, 25 January:** 95% of the reconstruction is completed, most of the houses constructed are load bearing (SMM, SMC, BMC), some are timber frame structure with ground floor BMC and first floor constructed using light materials. The RM representatives shared that there has not been enough coordination at RM on reconstruction and there has not been enough technical staff in the field. It was reported that due to delay in grievance results beneficiaries have not been able to start reconstruction and beneficiaries are facing challenge as there is no exact retrofitting model design or guideline.
- **Ward 7, Panchpokhari Thangpal RM, Sindhupalchok, 22 January:** it was reported that there is only one tablet in the ward office and the internet service is limited which is causing delay in CS entry. 300 beneficiaries have not received subsequent tranches since the district treasury office has not received grants from the central office. There are about 20-22 HHs that have not been able to start reconstruction due to poor economic condition. There are few houses that were constructed immediately after the earthquake and do not meet the standards for tranches. Some of the HHs have begun to construct new houses, mostly one room, to get the tranche.
- **Ward 3, Panchpokhari Thangpal RM, Sindhupalchok, 23 January:** engineers reported challenges in transporting inspection files from the ward to the Chautara District headquarter. At times, engineers have to travel 10 km away to the RM office to do CS entry. Most of the beneficiaries are migrant workers who reside abroad, and the villages are inhabited by senior citizens. This has caused difficulty in identifying the beneficiaries. The engineers complained that there has been a lack of training for them as well. There are about 20-30 households that have not started reconstruction. Most of these households are elderly people. When asked when they'll start, they'll say, "after my son returns who currently is abroad".
- **Ward 5, Panchpokhari Thangpal RM, Sindhupalchok, 23 January:** there has been delay in CS entry due to limited internet service. The field engineers also reported technical problem with the CS entry app. According to them, they uploaded the files and the details, which are shown in the tablet, but do not

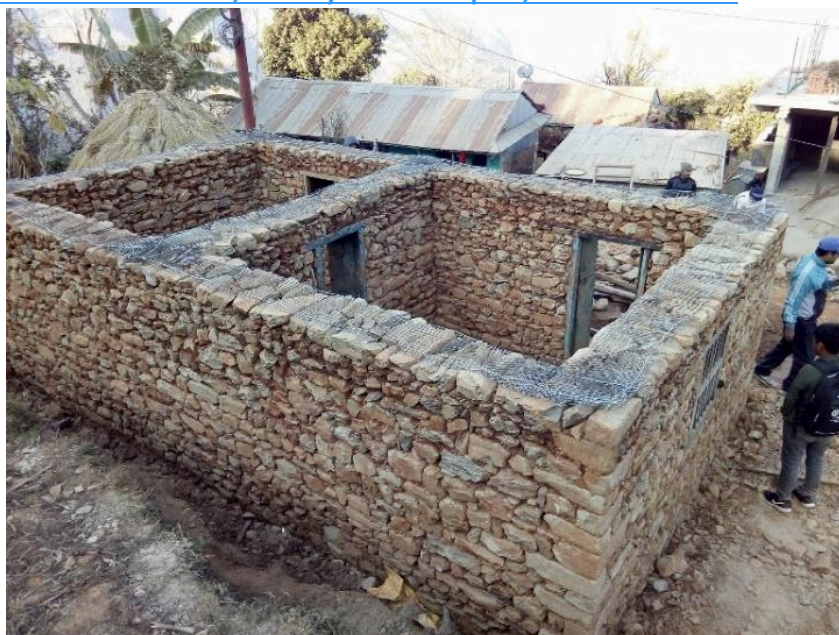
appear in the MIS system in the district. One of the beneficiaries' PA number was mistaken in the PA Card and the field engineers filled the inspection forms using the number. The beneficiary received the second tranche but has not been able to receive third tranche because of the mistake. The engineers were advised to contact the GMALI office and specify the Nissa Number (initial identification number) to correct the PA number. District treasury has stopped tranche release because of which ward representatives are facing pressure from the beneficiaries. The presence of engineer according to the ward secretary is satisfactory and thanked them for their support in reconstruction.

**HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Weekly District Report, 18 – 31 Jan 2019**



**Ward No. 2, Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Dhading:** a two storey hybrid structure with a brick and cement mortar masonry ground floor and timber frame with CGI sheets for the first floor. The floor area is less than 1,000 sq. ft. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

**HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 18 – 31 Jan 2019**



**Ward No. 2, Gandaki Rural Municipality, Gorkha:** two room, stone and mud mortar masonry house with guilded wire mesh bands. The home owner has received the first tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The house has been constructed with technical support from ODRC/UNDP.



**HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Valley, Weekly District Report, 18 – 31 Jan 2019**



**Ward No. 2, Kirtipur Municipality, Kathmandu:** 4 storey brick and mud mortar masonry house that was damaged by the earthquake. The house belongs to two people, one is a full reconstruction beneficiary and has received first tranche of the GoN housing grant while another house owner has been addressed through the grievance and is listed as beneficiary.

**HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhuli, Weekly District Report, 18 – 31 Jan 2019**



**Ward No. 7, Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Sindhuli:** two room, load bearing structure, stone and mud mortar masonry with RC bands. The home owner is a single woman who has received second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and has been approved for the third tranche. Honourable Province Member Lekhanath Dahal Rajan handed over the cheque to her. 50,000 NPRs as vulnerable top up support was provided by Mercy Corps. The house was constructed with technical support from Mercy Corps.

## Case Studies

**Yadu Kumar Shrestha**, resident of Sadananda Municipality-13, Bhojpur, has returned 50,000 NPRs through GMALI Office in Bhojpur. He returned the first tranche to NRA by depositing the amount in the NRA account opened in Rastriy Banijya Bank in Bhojpur. He stated that he could not construct his house as the fifty thousand is not enough to construct up to foundation level. His wife and son died during the earthquake and there is no one to support in the construction of the house and therefore he returned the amount voluntarily. He is living in his old damaged house in Bhojpur.

**Kamala Karki, Ward no. 3, Bhanjyang, Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu:** Kamala is 65, disabled, and lives alone. Her husband and daughter have been out of contact for many years. Kamala has problems with her speech and hearing, and also has difficulty walking. She lives in a 2 storey + attic, brick and mud masonry house (where she has lived for 35+ years) that was damaged by the 2015 earthquake. The house is on Parti land (common property owned by government) so Kamala has no land ownership papers. Kamala is living in one small area of her damaged house and uses a temporary toilet that was constructed for her by the community during an open defecation free campaign organised some time back. Kamala does not receive an old age pension and needs support from neighbours for food and other daily requirements. Kamala has signed the PA with the government, but she has not yet visited the bank to access the funds as she has no one to support her to travel there. The office of ward no. 3 Bhanjyang, Dakshinkali Municipality is appealing for support for Kamala to help her to progress through the reconstruction process and improve her living conditions. For more information please contact Mr. Karna Bahadur Shrestha, Acting Ward Chief, Ward no. 3, Bhanjyang, Dakshinkali Municipality, 9841540212, or Ms. Ambika Amatya, District Coordinator, Kathmandu Valley Team, HRRP, 9841356409, [dc.ktm@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:dc.ktm@hrrpnepal.org).



*Kamala sits outside her earthquake damaged house in Dakshinkali.*



**Featured Technical Staff Person, Sona Bade:** Sona began working on the reconstruction as part of the Building DLPIU team in Dhading from April 2016. Sona worked on the architectural design and detailing of damaged public buildings in Dhading Besi and as a DLPIU focal person was involved in verifying inspection files and providing support to the inspection engineers. Sona also supporting training for technicians and engineers.

Since December 2017, Sona has been working as a field engineer in wards 19 and 20 of Lalitpur Metropolitan City. Most houses in this area are brick faced and have been built integrating Newari architecture. A few months back, Sona was responsible for inspection of more than 1,500 houses across five wards but there are no more engineers and technicians on board and the numbers have reduced making the work much easier. Some households in wards 19 and 20 have received the second tranche but the third tranche has been put on hold due to the number of storeys that have been built being more than what is permitted near heritage settlements. Another issue is that sill and lintel bands were not included in many houses. The introduction of the Corrections and Exceptions Manual has supported with addressing this. Households that live in small inner courtyards cannot access bank loans for their housing reconstruction as it is impossible for them to meet the bank's requirements (e.g. road width). Households also regularly report issues with the building permit process, particularly the length of time required to go through the process. Sona also shared that there have been challenges for the inspection engineers when the municipality provides a completion certificate as part of the building permit process to a house that does not meet the technical requirements under the reconstruction process. The engineers are under a certain amount of pressure to approve the house for the third tranche because it has been approved by the municipality, but the engineers cannot approve it if it does not meet the minimum requirements.

Sona shared that so far it has been a great experience working in the field during reconstruction and she has really enjoyed working with and supporting households and contractors to build safer houses. Sona found that in Dhading and LMC, the home owners often struggle to know if their houses are being built well or not and are totally reliant on contractors. Sona found that talking to households during field visits and door to door visits enabled her to share information with households and masons that helped them to better understand the construction process and safer construction technology. However, Sona does share that there are still challenges for women working as engineers. The workplace is very male dominated and Sona found that households and communities were often more open to information and advice provided by male engineers than by women engineers.

Looking to the future, Sona shared that it will be important to consider the life span of buildings and to plan and implement building maintenance. Her experience has highlighted that even if a construction project looks good in the drawings and other relevant paperwork, it is quality control on site, during construction that is most important. Sona shared that public awareness programmes and training for masons / construction workers will be essential to address this. Sona also recommends developing a reconstruction review programme where the ongoing reconstruction activities can be analysed as a whole to enable better understanding of reconstruction issues and to guide policies for future reconstruction activities.



Sona and the participants in a 7 day mason training which was held in Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality, Dhading.



Sona delivering a session during training on inspection for NRA engineers.





*Sona conducting a house inspection in Nabahal, Ward 20, Lalitpur Metropolitan City.*

**Non-compliant Hybrid Structures, Chilankha, Ward No. 5, Bigu Rural Municipality, Dolakha:** there are non-compliance issues with the hybrid structures in this area mainly because people are not aware about the need for cross bracings. Cross bracings are the key element to resist earthquake force in hybrid structures with masonry ground floor and light timber frame first floor, but these are not being included in this area. The masons working in the area shared that they have completed mason training but had not learnt about bracing as part of this. The house owners in the area shared that they have found it difficult to organise visits from technical staff at the DLPIU. House owners are choosing to add the light timber frame structure as the ground floor alone is not sufficient for their living requirements and with the additional space they can use some of the ground floor for commercial purposes (the buildings are close to the road). These types of additions to houses to increase space to meet living requirements are increasingly being constructed without proper technical advice which is creating a major issue for the final inspection of the houses. Correction to such houses is also not easy without the support from local government because people are not willing to do corrections after receiving the third tranche. People do not see much value in the completion certificates so there is a challenge for the NRA to consider how to add value to the completion certificates as a way to ensure safe construction after the inspection for third tranche. The local government also have a big role to play in terms of implementation of building code, but as this is new for many local governments a great deal of support will be required.





## Requests for Partner Support

**REMINDER, HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey Round 4:** many thanks to the more than 200 people that already took the time to complete the fourth round of the HRRP partner satisfaction survey - we really appreciate your input! In order to give more people a chance to take part **the deadline for completing the survey has been extended to 8 February (Friday)**. As a stakeholder in the earthquake recovery and reconstruction effort the HRRP is your platform and your feedback will help to shape it. The survey can be conducted in **Nepali or English**. It should take **approximately 10-15 minutes to complete** but may take longer if you choose to provide more detailed feedback in the open answer questions.

**Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG), Working Sessions, 7 & 14 February, 1-5PM, HRRP Office:** anyone interested to join or requiring additional information can contact Rupa Pandey ([meal@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:meal@hrrpnepal.org)) or Minar Thapa Magar ([minar@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:minar@hrrpnepal.org)).

**Affordable Housing in Nepali Cities, 8 February, 9:30-12:15, DFID Nepal Ekantakuna:** as Nepal rapidly urbanises, there is an opportunity for cities to be centres of economic productivity. However, as is evident, the current rate of growth is outpacing capacity to plan and finance service delivery, which is increasing the cost of provision and distorting land markets. Provision of housing is central to creating liveable and affordable cities, enabling all citizens to access jobs and services. However, with rapid, unplanned urban growth, provision of housing is highly expensive, with poorer people forced to live on the margins of cities, often on contested land, without adequate shelter. The DFID funded Community-Led Infrastructure Financing Facility (CLIFF) has been supporting partners to develop pilot models for affordable housing provision, in Nepal and across Africa and Asia. During this event, Reall, Sewa, and Lumanti will be sharing their experience in convening stakeholders to develop projects that address this critical need in Nepal's cities. DFID Nepal invites you to attend what promises to be an interesting set of presentations and discussion on models for affordable service provision, working with urban municipalities, resolving land issues and access to finance. Please RSVP to Eleanor Bainbridge, [e-bainbridge@dfid.gov.uk](mailto:e-bainbridge@dfid.gov.uk).

**Working Together for Disaster Relief - How can the private sector better work with the humanitarian sector in pre- and post-disaster reconstruction and development to reinforce local ownership and support localisation?, BRE Event, 8 February, UK:** this one-day conference is an opportunity for the private and humanitarian sectors to meet and consider how to work together to support and develop local capacity for longer term sustainability and resilience. It will take the form of presentations about current and proposed initiatives and collaborative workshops discussing various issues related to collaboration between humanitarian, governmental, academic, and private partners. Whilst the event is taking place in the UK, it is possible to take part online also. Experience in Nepal on localisation and collaboration with private sector will be shared through presentations at the event as well as presentations via remote conferencing link between Nepal and the UK:

- Humanitarian and private sector collaboration: lessons from the response to the Nepal Earthquake 2015, Shuva Sharma, Scott Wilson Nepal
- Strengthening supply chain of construction materials in earthquake-affected districts of Nepal, Dr Sujan Piya, Practical Action Nepal
- Post-Earthquake Reconstruction of Energy-efficient, environment-friendly and structurally-resilient brick kilns, Usha Manandhar, MinErgy Nepal

At the end of February / beginning of March, a one-day follow up event will be held in Nepal to bring together the private and humanitarian sectors to meet and consider how to work together to support and develop local capacity for longer term sustainability and resilience specifically in the Nepal context. This event is being organised by HRRP's private sector working group and more details will be shared soon. For more information, and / or to join the private sector working group, please contact Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP Deputy National Coordinator, [minar@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:minar@hrrpnepal.org).

**[Launch of ALNAP Earthquake Lessons Paper, 13 February, 10:00-13:00, Dhokaima Cafe:](#)** please join ALNAP and HRRP for the launch of a new ALNAP lessons paper capturing learning from earthquake response worldwide over the past decade, including the 2015 Nepal earthquake response. ALNAP (Active Learning Network for Accountability and Performance in Humanitarian Action) is a network of humanitarian organisations focused on learning. ALNAP lessons papers gather learning from responses to previous crises in order to inform response to future crises. ALNAP recently updated the methodology used to produce these sorts of papers in order to improve the rigour and transparency of the method. The first lessons paper to use this new methodology focuses on lessons around earthquake response. The paper is being launched in both English and Nepali and the launch event will feature a presentation and Q&A with the paper's author, Helene Juillard. It will also include presentations/commentary from stakeholders involved in the Nepal earthquake response, reflecting on the relevance of the newly published lessons for future earthquakes in Nepal and regionally. Light lunch will be served after the event. To attend, please RSVP by email to Rashmi Lama, [admin@hrrpnepal.org](mailto:admin@hrrpnepal.org), by 11 February.

## GoN Products

**[NRA Newsletter January 2019](#)**

## HRRP Products

**5W Products** are prepared based on the [latest round of 5W data, as of 25 December 2018](#). **Housing reconstruction progress maps** are prepared based on Building CLPIU data as of 5 January 2019.



### Technical Assistance for Housing Reconstruction - Coverage of Activities

[7 TA Activities-32 districts](#)  
[7 TA Activities - Eastern Cluster](#)  
[7 TA Activities - Central Cluster](#)  
[7 TA Activities - Western Cluster](#)  
[Short Training Coverage](#)  
[Vocational Training Coverage](#)  
[Community & HHs Orientation](#)  
[Demonstration Construction](#)  
[Door to Door Technical Assistance](#)  
[Helpdesks/Tech. Resource Centres](#)



### Sector Wise Maps of EQ affected districts

[Agriculture, Livestock Dev, Irrigation](#)  
[Disaster Risk Management](#)  
[Education](#)  
[Employment and Livelihood](#)  
[Gender Equality and Social Inclusion](#)  
[Health](#)  
[Nutrition](#)  
[Social Protection](#)  
[Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene](#)  
[Number of POs in each ward](#)  
[Number of sectors in each ward](#)



### Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps

[PA agreement between HHs and GoN](#)  
[Construction Started](#)  
[1st tranche received](#)  
[Compliance rate 2nd tranche](#)  
[Compliance rate 3rd tranche](#)  
[Construction completed](#)

## Partner Products

**Municipal Association of Nepal (MuAN) Mobile App:** the app provides information such as contact details, websites, details of municipal officials, maps, etc. for all municipalities in Nepal. More information on MuAN can be found through the website - <https://muannepal.org.np/>.

**National Association of Rural Municipalities in Nepal (NARMIN) Mobile App:** the app provides information such as contact details, websites, details of municipal officials, maps, etc. for all Rural Municipalities in Nepal. More information on NARMIN can be found through the website - <http://www.navin.org.np/>.

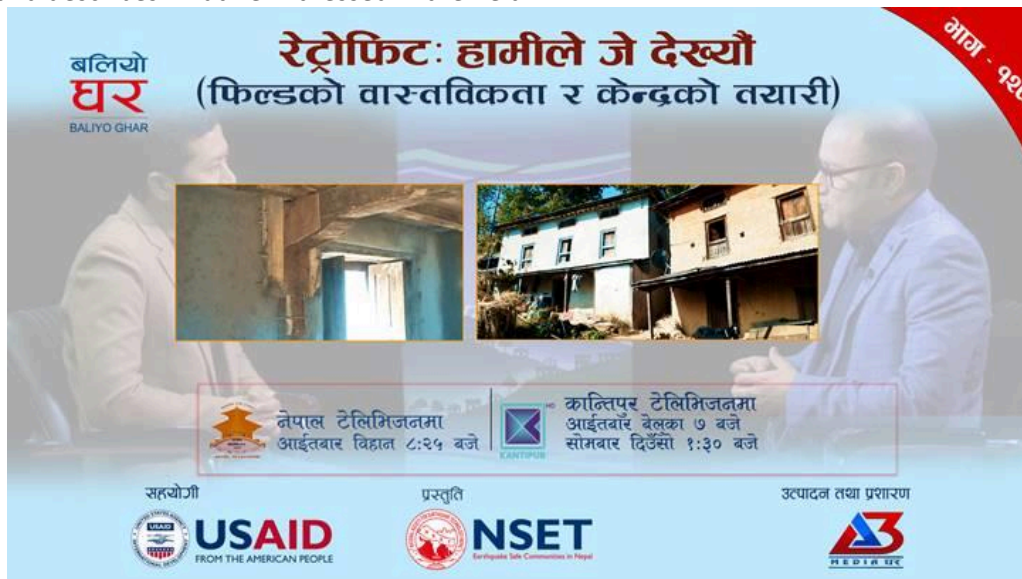
**Proceedings of the 2019 International Conference on Disaster Risk Management, 12-14 January 2019:** both keynote speakers and researchers from Nepal participated in the event. The conference was organised by Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology-Japan Institute of Disaster Prevention and Urban Safety (BUET-JIDPUS) Dhaka, Bangladesh, along with the BUET Departments of Architecture and Urban and Regional Planning, the BUET Institute of Water and Flood Management, Urban Resilience Project: RAJUK Part, and Bangladesh Fire Service and Civil Defence.

**Milijuli Nepali, Episode 1176:** this episode was recorded in Myagdi, Khotang, and Arghakhanchi districts. The first story is of Laxmi Raj Bhandari of Aaiselukharka, Khotang. She says that the people in her village have been discussing retrofitting as an option to preserve the traditional houses in their village. The second story is of Geeta Subedi who is also from Arkhauli Khotang. She shares about how she tried to preserve her old the house by herself as she did not have information on retrofitting. Now, she wants to consult an engineer for retrofitting. The third story is of Bir Bahadur from Myagdi. He shares about the differences about old and new houses and says that traditional houses are now rare to find. The last story in the episode is of Saligram Thapa of Arghakhanchi. He says



that doing a demonstration retrofit can help encourage people to retrofit as houses in his village have cracks which require retrofitting.

**Baliyo Ghar TV, Episode 129:** this episode is focused on stories of retrofitting issues and progress from Okhaldhunga. During the episode the programme producer, Mr. Shiva Shrestha, shares his experience in Okhaldhunga and describes what he witnessed in the field.



**EHA Connect, 'Connecting Environment and Humanitarian Action':** EHA Connect is a tool bringing the humanitarian and environmental communities together to support environmentally sustainable disaster management. The tool helps environmental actors engage in the disaster space and humanitarians develop more resilient emergency management systems. This tool has just gone live, and will be formally launched during the [Humanitarian Networks and Partnerships Week \(HNPW\) in Geneva](#), 4-8 February 2019.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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